

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 683

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Robert Earl "Bob" Nelson of Erwin.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Colonel (Retired) Robert Earl "Bob" Nelson of Erwin; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Nelson was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, lovingly known as "Peewee" by his friends, Bob Nelson was a native of Erwin and the son of the late Earl Nelson and the late Judy Bell White Bailey; and

WHEREAS, a proud and highly decorated veteran, Mr. Nelson served in the United States Air Force, the United States Army, and the Tennessee Army National Guard from 1974 until 2012, and, for his service, he was honored with the Legion of Merit, two Bronze Stars for Meritorious Service, the Meritorious Service Medal, in addition to other awards and commendations; and

WHEREAS, during his service, Bob Nelson had two deployments: his first from 1990 to 1991 in Operation Desert Shield and Operation Desert Storm and his second to Kuwait at Camp Arifjan, where he served as Deputy Commander of the 21st Theater Support Command in support of Operation Enduring Freedom and Operation Iraqi Freedom in Afghanistan; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Nelson was a devoted man of God who loved his church and church family; he was a loyal member of West Park Street Baptist Church; and

WHEREAS, Bob Nelson especially enjoyed spending time with his family, fixing and building items, riding his tractor, and helping others; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Nelson was deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Bob Nelson will be sadly missed but fondly remembered by his beloved wife of fifty-four years, Freda Nelson; his daughters, Jennifer (Terry) Franklin and Sharon Shadrick; his grandchildren, Sarah (Russell) Brackins, Kayla Shadrick (Jeff) Rice, Ashley Shadrick (Shaun), Erica Franklin (Stephen) Hill, and Phillip Franklin; his great-grandchildren, Christopher, Mason, Thomas, Bella, Lilly, Gabe, Summer, Amelia, Carson, Winter, Zach, and Waylon; and several other family members and friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Mr. Nelson was preceded in death by his stepfather, Herman Bailey; granddaughter, Jessica Hope Franklin; brothers, Harold Nelson and Frank Nelson; and an infant sister; and

WHEREAS, Bob Nelson leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Colonel (Retired) Robert Earl "Bob" Nelson, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Mr. Nelson.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.